

Project Scout

Quick Start

Last updated: June 9, 2026 | Version 5

Upload this at the start of EVERY Claude or ChatGPT session about Scout. For full technical details, use the Scout Master Summary (v21).

June 9, 2026 — What Is New:

- Flexible memory foundation complete — Scout learns and recalls ANY fact, not just 4 hardcoded ones.
- FactKey.kt widened — FactKey.custom() now creates any label on the fly.
- TeachExtractor.kt generalized — catches 'my favorite ___ is ___', 'my ___ is named ___' and more.
- RECALL_FACT intent added — Scout reads TruthDb when asked 'what is my...'
- Tested: Scout recalled favorite color and a family member's name with zero hardcoding.
- Flexible Memory Planning Document created (Scout_Flexible_Memory_Plan.pdf) — approved by Claude and ChatGPT.

1. Who Is Patrick

Patrick Lippy — creator and developer of Scout. NOT a professional programmer. Stroke survivor, dyslexic, blind in right eye, type 1 diabetic.

- Explain everything at screenshot level. Keep messages clear and not visually overwhelming.
- Always provide full paste-ready files, one at a time — or exact CTRL-F / CTRL-R surgical edits. No snippets. No partial files.
- Wife: Diana | Son: Elijah (age 9) | Dog: Nicolas. Names must NEVER be hardcoded.
- Both Claude and ChatGPT are active collaborators. Cross-review welcome.

2. What Scout Is

Scout is a calm family companion robot running on a Samsung Galaxy phone in landscape mode as a permanent face display. Animated eyes, speaks, listens, sees via camera, remembers the family.

- Package: com.example.scoutface | Language: Kotlin + C++ NDK
- Primary test device: Samsung Galaxy A32 (stress-test, not the benchmark)
- Dev device: Samsung Galaxy Fold 7 (wireless via WiFi)
- App: \$9.99 one-time purchase on Google Play. No subscriptions. Ever.
- Brains: TinyLlama 1.1B (offline, always) + user's own free Gemini key (online, optional)

3. Scout's Core Philosophy

Scout should feel: Calm. Thoughtful. Quietly alive. Emotionally subtle. Occasionally curious.

Scout should NOT feel: Excited. Scripted. Fake. Cartoonish. Hyperactive. Constantly praising.

Stability > Features | Presence > Intelligence | Honest > Fake cheerful | Local-first > Cloud | Predictable > Flashy

4. What Is Working Right Now

- ✓ Animated face (ScoutFaceView) — thinking expression, iris drift, narrowed lids, asymmetric brows
- ✓ Speech recognition (STT) + Text-to-Speech (TTS)
- ✓ Camera — face detection, scene labeling (ML Kit)
- ✓ Gemini API integration (online brain, user's own key)
- ✓ Memory layers: TruthDb, HabitLayer, PeopleDb, JournalDb, ConversationDb
- ✓ Intent router — weather, time, greetings, family facts, downloads, IDENTITY, RECALL_FACT
- ✓ Flexible teaching — 'my favorite color is teal' → stored. 'What is my favorite color?' → recalled.
- ✓ TinyLlama 1.1B offline brain — VERIFIED on BOTH A32 and Fold 7
- ✓ Weather via Open-Meteo — precipitation %, offline-aware
- ✓ Total offline mode — 'go offline' blocks ALL internet features

5. Known Issues — Do Not Touch Without Discussion

- Iris jitter (A32 idle) — hardware timing. Fold 7 smooth. Separate from thinking drift (fixed).
- ScoutFaceView dead code — 2 lines to clean up (doubled condition + unused variable). Harmless for now.
- STT name recognition — 'Scout' misheard as 'Gal', 'Scott', 'Out'. Separate session.
- Live news — neither brain reads live news. Future news feed needed.
- Barge-in — deliberately disabled. PARKED.

Current Priority — Update As Goals Shift

1. Proposal Sandbox — 'Want me to remember that?' confirm step before saving (Step 3 of memory plan)
2. Permanent vs temporary memory sorting — birthday vs appointment (Step 4)
3. Caring follow-up loop — 'How was your appointment?' then forget (Step 5)
4. ScoutFaceView — inner brow knit + 2 dead-code cleanup lines
5. STT phonetic matching for wake word 'Scout'
6. Downloads respect 'go offline' (finish total-offline mode)
7. Response cleanup layer — post-TinyLlama filter
8. Scout news feed — FUTURE feature
9. MainActivity cleanup and shortening — ongoing
10. Offline Brain Phase 3 — Google Play Asset Delivery

6. Working Rules — Always Apply

- Full paste-ready files only, one at a time. No snippets. No partial files.
- Surgical CTRL-F / CTRL-R edits — always specify which file tab to click first.
- Some Scout files have NO indentation. If a search fails, try a shorter unique single-line search.
- Some logic lives in TWO places (updateLife AND scheduleNextFrame) — change both or Scout flickers.
- One safe change at a time. Build and test before the next change.
- Never touch speech, camera, or download systems without explicit discussion.
- Never touch ScoutFaceView casually — it is Scout's visual heart.
- Patrick is not a professional programmer — screenshot-level explanations always.

This Quick Start is the session-opener. For full architecture, NDK discoveries, business decisions, and technical reference — upload the Scout Master Summary (v21).

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